

High-Protein Tomato, Mozzarella & Arugula Sandwich

This vegetarian sandwich is packed with protein, thanks to creamy fresh mozzarella cheese and plenty of walnuts blended into the roasted red pepper spread. The spread, reminiscent of romesco sauce, is versatile and can also be served as a dip or sauce—adding depth and complexity to dishes like grilled meats, seafood and vegetables—or as a topping for pasta.

By **Renu Anshie Dhar** | Updated on August 24, 2025

 Reviewed by Dietitian **Emily Lachtrupp, M.S., RD**

Active Time: 15 mins

Total Time: 15 mins

Servings: 4

Nutrition Profile:

No Added Sugar Sesame-Free Healthy Pregnancy Soy-Free Vegetarian High-Protein Egg-Free

Ingredients

1 cup roasted red peppers, plus 1 tablespoon liquid from jar, divided

1 cup walnuts

1 tablespoon red-wine vinegar

1 teaspoon paprika

1/2 teaspoon garlic powder

4 (3-ounce) ciabatta rolls, split horizontally

2 cups loosely packed baby arugula

1/2 cup thinly sliced red onion

8 (1-ounce) slices fresh mozzarella cheese

1 medium tomato, cored and cut into 8 (1/4-inch) slices

1/4 teaspoon salt

Directions

Step 1

Combine roasted red peppers, walnuts, vinegar, paprika and garlic powder in a food processor; process until a slightly chunky spread forms, 2 to 3 minutes, stopping to scrape down sides as needed and adding liquid from the pepper jar, 1 teaspoon at a time, as needed to help puree the mixture.

Step 2

Spread the pepper mixture evenly on cut sides of ciabatta rolls (about 2 tablespoons each). Top each bottom slice with 1/2 cup arugula, 2 tablespoons sliced onion, 2 mozzarella slices and 2 tomato slices. Sprinkle with salt. Top with the remaining ciabatta slices. Cut the sandwiches in half and serve.

Frequently Asked Questions

Can I use a blender to make the sauce?

We prefer using a food processor, but a blender would work just as well if that's what you have on hand.

How does this recipe differ from a caprese sandwich?

This recipe shares a few similar ingredients with a caprese sandwich—like the ciabatta bread, tomato and mozzarella cheese—but it has a lot more ingredients and different seasonings like the roasted red pepper spread, so it doesn't taste the same.

What should I serve with a Tomato, Mozzarella & Arugula Sandwich?

We suggest serving this sandwich with salads: pasta salads, fruit salads or leafy green and vegetable salads. For crunch, try our Microwave Potato Chips, which can be made a few days ahead of time.

Additional reporting by Carrie Myers, M.S. and Linda Frahm

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Nutrition Facts

Per serving: **Serving Size 1 sandwich** 577 calories; total fat 31g; saturated fat 8g; cholesterol 36mg; sodium 845mg; total carbohydrate 54g; dietary fiber 6g; total sugars 10g; added sugars 0g; protein 23g; vitamin c 66mg; calcium 411mg; iron 5mg; potassium 490mg

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